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Senior Full Stack Software Engineer

Cabinet Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 27th September 2026



Cabinet Office

Reference number

477192

Salary

£59,207 - £96,051

National min: £59,207 London min: £65,193 Offers above the band minimum are subject to our assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated at interview. Salaries over the band minimum will be paid as a non pensionable allowance. The maximum salary reflects the maximum possible digital allowance, as well as a London weighting.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

CO - Civil Service Strategy Unit

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

Bristol, Glasgow, London, Manchester, York

About the job

Job summary

The GRIP platform has a large user base, serving thousands of users across 250 public sector organisations. It is a full stack web application that helps government to manage and track its priorities and initiatives, and capture reporting on them, across all government departments, and for consumption by the most senior decision makers. The application has support and visibility at the very highest levels of the organisation. We also help to develop and maintain the government's Evaluation Registry, which tracks planned and completed evaluations of government's policies.

We are looking for a full-stack developer to join our small software engineering team, building and managing this critical part of Government's tooling. You will have the opportunity to have genuine impact on how Government manages its work and to contribute to its overall effectiveness.

Job description

We are at an exciting stage, as we becoming a critical part of how government manages its most important areas of work. This will mean working on how the application scales, building new features, and maintaining a reliable, high-quality service.

Main Responsibilities:

You will work on both the front and back end of the application, mainly in JavaScript, working with a range of AWS services. Our core stack includes React, Node.js, and Postgres, so you will need to be comfortable working with these. Other parts of our work are in Python, and experience of Python web frameworks, e.g. Django, would also be helpful. Each engineer is involved across the full range of responsibilities. Your work will therefore include managing our infrastructure and responding to any performance issues, building server functionality and new microservices, database management and schema changes, prototyping and building new front-end features, and testing and deployment. There will also be opportunities to

engage directly with users in a range of roles across government, and to help shape the overall direction of the product.

You can expect to have responsibility to:

Build accessible and interactive interfaces, server functionality, and microservices, taking responsibility for the quality of your code.

Decide and evolve how we structure and manage our data.

Be a confident communicator, able to bridge the gap between the technical and non-technical team members to build the right product.

Person specification

Essential experience

Experience of front-end development, with detailed knowledge of HTML, CSS and JavaScript.

Experience of technologies used for web applications, e.g. HTTPS, JSON and CDNs, and of Unix-like operating systems, e.g. Linux and/or Mac OS.

Experience of back-end data infrastructure, including SQL databases.

Understanding of software design principles, including progressive enhancement.

Experience in building robust and accessible interfaces that work for multiple users.

An understanding of front-end web performance.

Ability to quickly research and learn new programming tools and techniques.

Experience of writing robust code using approaches such as TDD/BDD, unit testing, integration testing and feature testing

Understanding of agile principles and working practices

Experience of code reviewing workflows and version control.

Experience of user-centred design principles and delivering to user needs.

Desirable experience

Deeper experience in any of our technology choices, or in web application security

Additional information:

A minimum 60% of your working time should be spent at your principal workplace. Although requirements to attend other locations for official business will also count towards this level of attendance.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Managing a Quality Service

Working Together

Changing and Improving

Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Software engineering skills, in line with the person specification and job description.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £59,207, Cabinet Office contributes £17,152 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme.

[Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Learning and development tailored to your role.

An environment with flexible working options.

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity.

A Civil Service Pension which provides an attractive pension, benefits for dependants and employer contributions of 28.97%.

A minimum of 25 days of paid annual leave, increasing by one day per year up to a maximum of 30.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Application process

We will assess applications against the Experience and Behaviours elements of the Civil Service Success Profiles:

[Behaviours](#) - the actions and activities that people do which result in effective performance in a job:

[Experience](#) - the knowledge or mastery of an activity or subject gained through involvement in or exposure to it.

As part of the application process you will be asked to complete a CV and personal statement (500 words).

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

We will sift applications by considering your experience, career history and achievements, relevant to the job role, as described in your Personal Statement and CV.

At this stage we will also consider how you have demonstrated the experience and technical skills you will need for the role.

Please provide a personal statement of no more than 500 words. It should explain how your knowledge, skills and experience (using examples) meet the requirements for this role in line with the Success Profile element(s) being assessed (e.g. Behaviours, Experience etc). Using the job advert information, particularly the job description and person specification. Information is available on the [application process](#) (including what Civil Service Success Profiles is) and how to write your [personal statement](#).

Selection process

Candidates who pass the sift will be invited to complete a technical exercise and an Interview.

For the **technical exercise**, you will be asked to take part in a pair programming exercise with two of our developers. The exercise will cover challenges similar to ones that you would be likely to encounter in the role. You will be asked to talk through your thought process, draw on your previous experience and offer solutions to the problems in the exercise.

The successful candidate might not resolve all issues in the example, but the ability to communicate and problem solve in a collaborative way will be necessary to a successful interview.

In the interview we will ask a range of technical questions, and also ask you to provide examples of how you meet each of the assessed Behaviours:

- Managing a quality service (lead behaviour)

- Working together

- Changing and improving

- Delivering at pace

We will ask follow up questions as appropriate.

The interview also provides an opportunity for you to ask any questions you may have regarding the role.

Expected timeline (subject to change)

Expected sift date - w/c 21st September

Expected interview date/s - w/c 5th October

Interview location - Your interview will be conducted by video. We will provide you with a link for the video call when we invite you to interview.

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service via cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

A reserve list may be held for a period of 12 months from which further appointments can be made.

Any move to Cabinet Office from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare; for further information [visit the Childcare Choices website](#).

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service/Disclosure Scotland on your behalf.

However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

For further information on the Disclosure Scotland confidential checking service telephone: the Disclosure Scotland Helpline on 0870 609 6006 and ask to speak to the operations manager in confidence, or email Info@disclosurescotland.co.uk

Please note that **this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 UK residency in the past 5 years**. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

Please note terms and conditions are attached. Please take time to read the document to determine how these may affect you.

Feedback

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application

for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Toby Williams

Email : toby.williams@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel that your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and wish to make a complaint, then in the first instance you should contact Government Recruitment Service by email at :

cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive, then you can contact the Civil Service Commission at info@csc.gov.uk. For further information on the Recruitment Principles and bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission, please visit their website at: <https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/>.

